



Planning approval and your Class 10 structure

Why a perfect certificate can still stall at the council — and how to know before you lodge.

DRAFT — NOT PUBLISHED. Technical content to be verified and completed by the registered building surveyor before release. Square-bracketed items need your numbers.

TWO APPROVALS, NOT ONE

The **building permit** (what our certificate supports) says the structure is safe and compliant. **Development approval** — "planning" — says it's allowed *there*: setbacks, streetscape, size. They're separate systems, and the council will not issue a building permit while a required planning approval is missing. It's the single most common reason a correctly certified Class 10 job stalls.

WHEN PLANNING APPROVAL IS USUALLY NOT NEEDED

- ✓ The structure sits **behind the front building line** and meets the R-Codes deemed-to-comply setbacks for its height and length.
- ✓ It's an ordinary ancillary structure — patio, shed, carport — of a size your local planning scheme exempts. [Confirm typical exemption thresholds to quote.]
- ✓ Boundary walls that fit within the R-Codes boundary-wall provisions for your area's R-coding. [Insert the limits you want quoted.]

WHEN IT USUALLY IS NEEDED

- Anything **forward of the front setback** — carports in front of the dwelling are the classic.
- **Setback variations** — closer to a boundary, longer or taller on the boundary, than the deemed-to-comply tables allow.
- Corner lots (sight lines), heritage areas, and estates with design guidelines.
- Retaining and fill that changes ground levels near boundaries.

Every council reads this differently. The R-Codes are state-wide but each local planning scheme adds its own exemptions and rules. When it's marginal, ask the council's planning desk — every Perth council is linked under **Resources → Your local government** — or ask us and we'll tell you which way it will land.

WHAT TO TELL US WHEN YOU LODGE

- ✓ Whether development approval **exists, is in progress, or isn't needed** — say which in the lodgement notes.
- ✓ A site plan with setbacks dimensioned to every boundary — it's how we (and the council) judge the planning question at a glance.
- ✓ If a variation is involved: the approval, or the neighbour comment the council collected.

